



IDOMENEO, FIRST PRINT, 1781

Mozart's *Idomeneo*, perhaps his greatest “serious opera,” tells of King Idomeneo’s promise to Neptune, god of the sea, to sacrifice the first person he sees in return for safe passage over the ocean. The first person Idomeneo sees is his very own son, Idamante—but in a change of heart, Neptune agrees to spare him if Idomeneo gives up his throne to the young man.



PRAGUE PIANO

During his visits to Prague, Mozart is believed to have